

SECURITY WATCH

Counter Strike 1.6 could get you hacked

According to a team of cybersecurity researchers over at Dr Web, an attacker has been using malicious gaming servers to silently compromise computers of Counter-Strike gamers worldwide by exploiting zero-day vulnerabilities in the game client.



Counter-Strike 1.6 contains multiple remote code execution (RCE) vulnerabilities in its client software. These vulnerabilities allow attackers to execute code of their choice on a gamer's system. It doesn't

require any additional interaction with the gamer. The Trojan 'Belonard', has been designed to gain persistence, replace the list of available servers, and create proxies to further spread the Trojan.

MOBILE WATCH

ZTE Axon V

Only seems like yesterday that the notch was a cutting edge addition to smartphone design, and yet, today, it seems like almost every smartphone manufacturer is trying their own unique take on how to avoid it altogether. Joining the line of weird camera customisations to avoid the notch, the ZTE Axon V takes your expectations and turns them on its head by placing 3D front cameras on one side of the phone. The design comes from a leak via Notebook Italia that claims it's a concept design, but also says that it might see a 2019 release. Beyond the protruding camera placement, the phone is supposedly coming with a 6.8-inch display in a 21:9 aspect ratio. The protrusion on the side houses two sensors vertically and is a static part of the frame.



APP WATCH

Bolo: Learn to read with Google

Learning a new language can be a daunting task. Bolo, a new app from Google, aims to fulfil that role by teaching children how to read English and Hindi. You start off with a few basic instructions from Diya, the built-in reading buddy, showing you how to go about learning on the app. Most of the initial learning involves reading stories in a line-by-line format, tapping on Diya to make her read out sentences that you do not

understand. Tapping on a particular word also shows how to read it out aloud with phonetics.

The app gamifies the experience by adding playable games at the end of each chapter. These games focus on different aspects of learning how to read, for instance, reading faster or spelling words out. Each successful activity on the app grants stars and milestones grant rewards that can be viewed in the rewards section. It congratulates you when you complete a sentence, especially if you do it fast. The app also seeks permission to profile a child based on their voice and the



image stored, so that multiple children can use the same app and yet maintain individual progress. Children can choose the profile by identifying their own picture or adding one when they start the app after the initial setup. There's also an option for parents to log-in where they can see the progress of each child in terms of the time spent and stars earned on the app. Over-

all, Bolo from Google is an app that is designed for India and is a highly beneficial app that we would like to recommend for anyone looking to teach their kids how to read.

Big Bang AR



An experience developed by CERN with Google, this app takes you on a journey through the universe from

the Big Bang to the present day in an immersive, interactive format.

Daywise



If you're tired of too many notifications, Daywise is an app that groups notifications by apps and people and

serves them to you at specified times during the day, with exceptions you can control.

Novel Effect: Read Aloud Books



While you read a story from a physical book or one from the app's library or from

connected ebook stores, this app plays relevant sound effects.